

SUMMARY

9 years guided by one principle: explorative research helps build the right thing, iterative research helps build things right. 9 years leading UX research across complex fintech apps, DeFi, SSI wallets, and developer tooling. I specialize in qualitative research methodology, discovery, PMF validation, and behavioral insights. I also build and maintain research ops processes from the ground up.

CORE SKILLS

User Research · Research Ops · Developer Experience (DevEx) · Product Discovery · PMF Validation · Jobs-to-be-Done Analysis · Qualitative & Quantitative Methods · User Segmentation · Behavioral Analysis · Insight Synthesis · Usability Testing · Diary Studies · Stakeholder Alignment · Research Repository Management · AI-assisted Research Workflows

EXPERIENCE

Thesis — UX Research & Product Design Lead

Apr 2021 - Jul 2025 · Remote

Thesis is a web3 venture studio that builds and incubates Bitcoin & Ethereum products. I led research and product design continuously across its portfolio, moving with the studio from one product to the next.

Mezo — UX Research Manager & Product Strategy · 2024-2025

- Led PMF-focused research across discovery, segmentation, and value-proposition validation — pinpointed the exact segment that responded to Mezo Borrow and invalidated lower-fit ones, concentrating effort on the top 35–40% of likely adopters.
- Partnered with the PMs on Mezo Borrow and Onboarding to translate findings into roadmap decisions, helping elevate Borrow to the flagship product driving most early engagement within two quarters.
- Built a centralized insight repository as the company's single source of truth, supporting 15+ stakeholders across Product, Design, Engineering, and Marketing.
- Ran Jobs-to-be-Done interviews and PMF surveys that aligned Product and Marketing on the target user, contributing to a 20% uplift in qualified traffic and early-stage conversion.

Threshold Network — UX Research & Design Lead · 2021-2024

- Led post-merger discovery and stakeholder alignment after the Keep + NuCypher merge — produced Brand Personality Guidelines, Target User Profiles, and validated hypotheses that minimized roadmap rework.
- Conducted deep research into Threshold's core audience (Bitcoin holders exposed to DeFi), validating risk tolerance, yield expectations, and trust barriers; insights drove early adoption of staking and bridging and growth in Total Value Locked (TVL).
- Owned end-to-end research and UX for the marketing website: segmented IA, user flows, wireframes, three rounds of usability testing → 30% improvement in first-time task success and a 22% lift in product engagement from website entry points.
- Led discovery and delivery for the Network Dashboard (onboarding, legacy stake migration, node-operator flows) → ~20% better onboarding completion and ~16% faster time-to-first-stake.
- Owned discovery and iteration for the tBTC bridge v2 → two validated iterations, ~18% higher bridge-completion rates.
- Created a diary-study + interview methodology for Node Operators that cut setup-related issues ~30% and improved operator-reported clarity.

Keep Network — UX Research & Design Lead · 2021

- Ran deep discovery on Node Operator behavior, uncovering a new high-value Staking Providers (B2B) segment → 15% increase in active Node Operators and 30% fewer setup drop-offs.
- Led end-to-end creation of Coverage Pools (first of its kind in Ethereum DeFi, pre-Aave) — locked 33% of total supply; 87% of test participants accurately recalled the full 3-step flow.

Also contributed research to **Acre** (Bitcoin liquid staking) and the **BitcoinFi Accelerator**.

Web3UX User Research Panel — Co-founder & Sole Owner

Apr 2022 - Present

- Co-founded Web3UX, now the sole owner — a user testing platform built specifically for web3 native users. Created to solve a core problem in decentralized product development: access to the right research participants. The platform connected web3 projects with real users for usability testing, discovery research, and behavioral studies.

Selfkey / KYC-chain — UX Researcher & Design Lead

Jul 2020 - Apr 2021

- Conducted User Research Interviews across both explorative and generative phases, using qualitative and quantitative methods.
- Organized Discovery Workshops in the early stages of product development to help the Product Team shape future features and products.
- Improved the onboarding and wallet recovery experience for the SelfKey wallet by adding Seed Phrase and Private Key login options, targeting issues specific to blockchain users.
- Worked on products like SelfKey Digital Identity Wallet, SelfKey Staking, SelfKey Marketplace, and KeyFi DeFi Aggregator.

Consensys / Alethio — Head of Design

Jul 2018 - May 2020

- Conducted User Research Interviews across both explorative and generative phases, using qualitative and quantitative methods.
- Organized UX Workshops to align stakeholders and define problems to solve.
- Led the experience, architecture, and interaction design for several of the company's tool flows and digital services, from incipient phase to launch-ready.
- Worked on products like Alethio Block Explorer, Alethio API, Alethio Monitoring (two versions), Alethio Design System, and other functionalities of the Ethereum Data Analytics Platform.

SELECTED TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

- Designing for Trust in Web3: Lessons from the User Research Field — EthCC[7] Cannes, 2025
- Elevating Developer Experience (DX) in web3 — a framework — EthCC[6] Paris, 2023 (with Daniel Luca)
- The Future of Web3UX — a Paradigm Shift for Better Collaboration between Design and Development — DevCon VI Bogota, 2022
- Accessibility: Ethereum for LITERALLY everyone! — EthCC[4] Paris, 2022
- That never even crossed my mind! How to spot & fix your cognitive biases — EthCC[3] Paris, 2020
- User Research: How to Get Out of Our Bubbles by Talking to Users — DevCon V Osaka, 2019 (with Georgia Rakusen)

EDUCATION

Master Degree of Architecture (M.Arch) — Ion Mincu University of Architecture and Urbanism, Bucharest, 2005–2011